



Mono Laser Printers (SoHo)

Canon LBP 2900

Specs: 600 x 600 dpi x dpi, 150-Sheet Input Tray Capacity, Additional Paper Tray, Toner Duty Cycle 2,000 Pages, USB 2.0 and Parallel Interfaces

Our Verdict: The LBP 2900 is a small, stylish printer. It features an additional paper tray, and you have the option of adding a network card if and when you feel the need to use this printer on a network. The printer supports both Windows and Linux.

This was one of the fastest printers we'd seen, and we found the print quality



the best in the category. Remember, also, that this is a Canon, and Canon has a good number of service centres all over the country. The price of this printer is amongst the lowest in its class.

Runner-Up: Lexmark E230

Mono Laser Printers (Workgroup)

Brother HL-6050D

Specs: 600 x 600 dpi x dpi, 500-Sheet Input Tray Capacity, Additional Paper Tray, Toner Duty Cycle 7,500 pages, USB 2.0 and Parallel Interfaces

Our Verdict: The HL-6050D is targeted at small- to medium-sized offices. You won't complain about the input tray capacity, nor about the additional paper tray! There is support for printing languages such as PCL6 and PS3, which means it consumes very little system resources.

This wasn't the fastest printer in its category, but it was still very fast; in terms of print quality, it was the best

amongst the printers it was compared with.

A duty cycle of 7,500 pages is considerably high, and the printer yields the lowest cost per page among all the printers in its class. Throw in a three-year on-site warranty with 105 service centres across the country, and factor in the low price—and you've got a sure Zero1 Award winner in the Brother HL-6050D.



Runner-Up: Brother HL-5140

Colour Laser Printers

Epson AcuLaser C1100

Specs: 600 x 600 dpi x dpi, 180-Sheet Input Tray Capacity, Dual-Side Printing, Windows and Mac ready, Network Port, USB 2.0 and Parallel Interfaces

Our Verdict: The AcuLaser C1100 has a unique, boxy look. It supports dual-side printing, which allows you to print something like a book or a manual without the need for human intervention. There's an LCD screen that displays the status of the task being carried out. It is network-enabled, which is especially useful in offices.

This colour printer was the fastest of them all, be it text documents, combi-documents or colour photo printouts. The price is also lower than that of most in this category.



Epson has a network of 211 service centres across the country.

Runner-Up: Samsung CLP-500

PROCESSORS

AMD Athlon64 X2 4800+

Specs: 2.4 GHz, Dual-Core, 1 MB L2 Cache per Core, Socket 939

Our Verdict: Based on the low power consuming Venice core, this dual-core processor has a stock clock speed of 2.4 GHz. It supports various instruction sets such as 3DNow!, MMX, SSE, SSE-2, and SSE-3—minus the hyperthreading components, which are Intel specific. It works with all the 939-pin motherboards available, provided the BIOS is updated to recognise this new processor.

This is a 64-bit processor, but remember that to experience the extra power afforded, a 64-bit OS must be used. As you might expect, this 64-bit



dual-core returned superlative performance in every single benchmark that was thrown its way. There is simply *no* other processor today that can come close to the Athlon 64 X2's lightning-fast performance!

Runner-Up: None